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Module Handbook

OCOM5202M Ethics of Artificial Intelligence

22/23 (L02)

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Accessibility

For information in alternative formats please email DESstudents@leeds.ac.uk or speak with your Student Success Advisor.

Welcome to the Module

Welcome to OCOM5202M Ethics of Artificial Intelligence.

This handbook contains administrative information related to the module to help you to organise study time for the module. We hope that you find this material useful and the work you do on the module rewarding.

Module Team

Your module leader is Robbie Morgan. You will have the opportunity to speak to him during the live weekly webinar sessions in Unit 1. If you need to contact Robbie directly, you can find his details in the ‘Staff Information’ section of Minerva. Please note: Robbie can be contacted via email.

Your unit tutors are:

Units 1 and 2: Paula Satne

Units 3 and 4: Robbie Morgan

Units 5 and 6: Sophie Goddard

Details of how to contact your unit tutors can be found in the ‘Staff Information’ section of Minerva.

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Module Objectives

This module aims to explore the ethical considerations involved in AI. The workplace, home and public spaces are going through a technological revolution. In particular, the combination of automation and machine learning may take many consequential decisions that are currently made by human beings and delegate them to computer algorithms. This module provides you with the analytical and theoretical tools to engage with the ethical questions that this raises, such as: Who is morally responsible when an automated system makes a mistake? Who is morally responsible if a self-learning algorithm develops and enacts prejudices? Is it a good idea to remove the need for interpersonal trust from professional interactions? What rights do consumers have over their personal information? How do organisations respect clients' best interests, and the public interest, in gathering, storing, and using data? You will also have the opportunity to apply the academic skills you have learned in the module to concrete issues and case studies in AI.

Learning Outcomes

Successful completion of this module will help you to:

- Identify and comprehend ethical issues in a professional context
- Be familiar with several key areas of ethical concern in the intersection of technology and the workplace;
- Analyse applied ethical arguments to masters level
- Make and defend applied ethical arguments to masters level
- Communicate applied ethical analysis and argument through written and verbal presentation to masters level.

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Syllabus

Unit 1 – Big data: consent and privacy

In this unit, you will learn about consent, privacy and autonomy and consider how these concepts might apply to AI. The examples and case studies provided will help you to reason critically through why privacy, consent and autonomy are ethically important to uphold in data and AI contexts.

Unit 2 – Big data: surveillance and responsibility

In this unit, you will learn about the ethics of surveillance in the context of AI, exploring themes of responsibility and the value of privacy. You will examine what is meant by surveillance and the ethical issues that this raises, the complexities facing the use of AI in surveillance, and the business of surveillance capitalism (including potential solutions). You will also discuss the panopticon, facial recognition technology in cities, and digital minimalism.

Unit 3 – AI and automation: machine learning and bias

This week introduces you to artificial intelligence (AI) and automation with the focus on machine learning and bias. Automation is one of the main areas of ethical discussion around the use of artificial intelligence, particularly machine learning forms of AI. You will explore this issue by thinking about your initial reflections on the topic, considering some case studies and answering some questions about the case studies and readings. Through this, you will begin to realise when bias is unfair and becomes ethically concerning. Then you will examine what can be done to address bias and have ethical awareness of it, or through finding technical methods through it.

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Unit 4 – AI and automation: assessing vulnerability, best interests and the public interest

In this unit, you will consider the ethical implications of automating technology and using AI, and explore the debates for and against this subject. You will build on the material covered in unit 3, where you learned how AI solutions can be problematic due to issues of bias, by exploring how, even by discounting bias or creating an AI system with no bias, there are still limitations to overcome - and these problems have ethical implications.

Unit 5 – AI and automation: the implications for trust and work

In this unit, you will consider the wider impacts that increased use of AI may have on communities, and how to evaluate these impacts from an ethical standpoint. We will examine the idea of an ‘externality’ that results as a by-product from an activity, and how externalities compound when an activity becomes widespread. We will then discuss particular externalities related to the use of AI. We will look at the ‘observer effect’ and the problem of feedback loops as algorithms continue to act upon on their own effects. We’ll discuss the problem of ‘black-box’ or opaque AI, which makes decisions without clear reasoning. We’ll finally consider, in light of these issues, whether regulation ought to limit the scope of how and where algorithms can be used.

Unit 6 – AI and automation: professionalism and responsibility

In this unit, you will explore the features and practices common to professions and consider whether the field of Artificial Intelligence should professionalise or not. You will also examine the conditions for responsibility and apply them to the possible consequences of AI. Finally, you’ll evaluate the value of professions having their own codes of ethics, and what the implications of this could be for your own practice in the field of artificial intelligence.

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Key Dates

	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
Unit 1	**3 July** Module starts	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**
Unit 2	**10** Unit 1 webinar 12:00-13:00 Assessment 1 Discussion forum post	**11**	**12**	**13**	**14**
Unit 3	**17** Unit 2 webinar 12:00-13:00 Assessment 1 Discussion forum post	**18**	**19**	**20**	**21**
Unit 4	**24** Unit 3 webinar 12:00-13:00	**25**	**26**	**27**	**28**
Unit 5	**31** Unit 4 webinar 12:00-13:00	**1 August**	**2**	**3**	**4**
Unit 6	**7** Unit 5 webinar 12:00-13:00 Assessment 1 Discussion forum post	**8**	**9**	**10**	**11**
Unit 7	**14** Unit 6 extended webinar 12:00-13:30	**15**	**16**	**17**	**18**

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Study break	**21** **Assessment 1 deadline** **Assessment 2 deadline**	**22**	**23**	**24**	**25**

Please see the module area in Minerva for specific timings for webinars and assessment submission deadlines.

Please note that **the University of Leeds will be closed** on the following dates:

28 and 29 August 2023 due the bank holiday.

Module Assessment

You should familiarise yourself with the Digital Education Service Code of Practice on Assessment (CoPA) before you start your first assignment. The CoPA contains important information about marking, late submissions, resits, mitigating circumstances and more.

Assessment 1: Discussion Forum posts

Summary

In this assignment, you will make three contributions to the discussion forums in Units 2, 3 and 6.

Deadline

Release date: Monday 3rd July at 08:30 UTC +1 (London)

Due: Monday 21st August at 08:30 UTC +1 (London)

Purpose

The discussion forum is a space to engage in critical written argument and reflection on the ethical issues that are raised in the content of the module. By offering your own individual reasoned viewpoint, and then reflecting and critically engaging with others' reasoned views, you will gain a better understanding of the issues themselves, engage in constructive dialogue with your peers, and develop critical argument and analysis skills.

Key Information

This assessment consists of making contributions to three assessed discussion forums in **Units 2, 3 and 6.** You will contribute your reasoned views on the ethical issues raised in each unit by answering a set of discussion forum questions and by responding to the posts of your fellow students.

To ensure successful completion of this assessment, you must:

1. Post your contributions to the relevant discussion forums (Unit 2: Section 2 Assessed Discussion: Facial Recognition; Unit 3 Section 4: Assessed Discussion; Unit 6 Section 2 Assessed Discussion: Should AI be considered a profession?).
2. Complete the Assessment 1 template by cutting and pasting in all parts of your three contributions and submitting this completed template for marking.

Please note: for the Unit 2: Section 2 Assessed Discussion you will be assigned a side of the debate to respond to. You will receive this via email by the end of unit 1. If you have not received an email by this time, please email DESCourseSupport@leeds.ac.uk

You must complete both of these tasks by the due date for the assessment.

A ‘contribution’ consists of your initial post and then 1-3 responses to the posts of others, where you will engage with your fellow students and discuss ideas.

There is in principle no upper word limit for your contributions. However, if in need of an upper boundary as a guide for yourself – once you are approaching having written **4000 words** *overall* across the posts, you can consider yourself as having written more than enough. But to be clear: you are not *expected* or *required* to write this much, and markers will not be keeping track of word counts for what you write. Instead, markers will primarily be focusing on how well your contributions exhibit the qualities detailed in the marking criteria, rather than how well you contribute posts for the sake of doing so.

If you keep writing and writing, this will be a case of 'diminishing returns'. Also, you can often increase the clarity of your points / arguments by being concise and precise in your wording.

Assessed forums will have edit functionality for individual posts switched off so that you cannot return to edit your contribution later.

Task

Throughout the module, you will be asked to contribute your reasoned views on the ethical issues raised in each unit, in a set of discussion forum tasks. You’ll also be asked to discuss these issues with fellow students and engage with (challenge, critique, explore, elaborate on)

their contributions too. This will be part of the learning process, helping you develop your critical analysis and argumentation skills.

When contributing, it is important to make clear the following:

- The **purpose** of your post (e.g. is it to give your viewpoint and explain your reasoning for it? Is it to offer a challenge to another student's viewpoint? Is it to elaborate on or lend further support to another student's viewpoint? Does it do all of these / more?)
- Any **reasoning** (evidence, support, arguments) for **endorsing** a given proposal (view, position) on the issue under discussion

And/or:

- Any **reasoning** (evidence, support, arguments) for **rejecting** a given proposal (view, position) on the issue under discussion

Typically, you can arrive at these by considering, when asked to respond to a given question, these sorts of prompts for further thinking:

1. What is your initial reaction to that question?

2. Why did you have your reaction? Why might it be an accurate judgement?

3. Are there any ways you can question your reaction? Why might it be too quick a judgement?

4. Are the points identified in (3) problematic for your thoughts on (1) and (2)?

Prompt (**1)** can help you arrive at your view.

Prompt (**2**) can help you arrive at reasons to agree with your view.

Prompt (**3**) can help you arrive at possible objections to your view.

Prompt (**4**) can help you arrive at ways of resolving those objections. Or: it could help you arrive at reasons for rejecting your initial viewpoint in (**1**).

Your contributions will be assessed at the end of the module, meaning that you can post your contributions until the conclusion of Unit 7. You are encouraged to make your contributions during the week in which you study each unit, but you may also revisit the forums in later weeks to submit your responses.

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When you have posted all your contributions, you must complete the Assessment 1 template to submit your contributions for marking. You should download the blank template and copy and paste in all three of your contributions, under the relevant subheadings. This template must be submitted before the due date to ensure successful completion of this assessment.

Note that engaging fully with the non-assessed discussion forums (those in other units) is necessary for gaining a holistic understanding of the topic and developing your discussion skills. The more opportunities you take for collaborating in discussion with fellow students, the more you develop the skills and knowledge to demonstrate in the assessments.

Presentation

Your discussion forum posts should adhere to the guidelines on contributing to assessed discussions as set out in **Section 3.2a of the Code of Practice on Assessment.**

There is in principle no upper word limit for your contributions. However, if in need of an upper boundary as a guide for yourself – once you are approaching having written 4000 words overall across the posts, you can consider yourself as having written more than enough. But to be clear: you are not expected or required to write this much, and markers will not be keeping track of word counts for what you write. Instead, markers will primarily be focusing on how well your contributions exhibit the qualities detailed in the marking criteria, rather than how well you contribute posts for the sake of doing so.

If you keep writing and writing, this will be a case of 'diminishing returns'. Also, you can often increase the clarity of your points / arguments by being concise and precise in your wording. You must ensure that you submit the requisite contribution to each assessed discussion board.

For further information about what is included in the word count, please refer to **Section 3.3d of the Code of Practice on Assessment**.

Referencing

When drawing on further reading sources in developing your arguments, it is helpful and good academic practice to include references for those sources that you have drawn on, which cannot be taken as obviously under discussion (for example, the assigned text in guided reading exercises in this case). It is also helpful and good practice to give page numbers for

anywhere you're referring to a specific claim/idea/argument from another author. For the purposes of meeting the marking criteria, it is encouraged to give references for your sources, in demonstrating your preparation and preparedness for the discussions.

All sources that you draw on should be correctly referenced using the Harvard style. Please see the Library webpages for guidance.

Academic Integrity

As a student at the University of Leeds, you need to adhere to the University's regulations on academic misconduct. All work you submit for assessment is expected to be your own independent work. Where you have worked with others or where you present other people's work as part of your assessment, you must fully acknowledge this.

All students should ensure that they are aware of the principles of Academic Integrity. For more information or if you are unsure about academic integrity, please read the University of Leeds' guidance on Academic Integrity. Please note that by submitting this piece of work you are agreeing to the University's Declaration of Academic Integrity.

Submission

There are two aspects to complete for successful submission of this assessment:

1. Submit your contribution (initial post and responses) to the relevant assessed discussion forums on the Unit pages. You must ensure that all of your contributions have been made to the three discussion forums by the conclusion of Unit 7 and no later than the due date.
2. Complete the Ethics of AI Assessment 1 template and submit by the due date and time via the submission link in the 'Submit my Work' area of the module.

Once you have posted your contributions to the three assessed discussion forums, you will need to collate them and prepare them for submission and marking.

As you copy and paste in your posts and responses, you also need to provide the date and time of the post that you are copying. This is important as it will help your module tutors locate

the post 'in situ' on the discussion forums, to be able to see the debate and wider critical engagement around your post.

When you have copied in all relevant content, please remember to update the Contents table on page 1 of the template by selecting Update Table of Contents and then selecting the Update page numbers only option.

Remember to save your submission and use your 9 digit student ID number as the document file name. Please include Please include the assessed work cover sheet when you submit your work.

Marking

This is a compulsory assessment for **OCOM5202M Ethics of Artificial Intelligence**. It is worth **20%** of your overall module grade.

The marks will be distributed using the attached assessment criteria.

Feedback

You will receive your mark and feedback via Minerva in the **Gradebook** section, accessed from the main navigation menu at the top of the page.

We will notify you by email when your feedback is available. You will usually receive feedback within 15 working days of the assignment deadline.

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Assessment 2: Video Presentation

Summary

A 15-minute, self-recorded video presentation concerning an ethical issue related to AI.

Deadline

Release date: Monday 3rd July at 08:30 UTC +1 (London)

Deadline: Monday 21st August at 08:30 UTC +1 (London)

Purpose

The purpose of the video presentation assessment is to aid further fulfilment of each of the module learning outcomes. The video presentation is an opportunity to present your reasoned view on one of the ethical issues that are raised in the content of the module. This will be the key opportunity to exhibit the skills in verbal communication, analysis and argument you've developed, and to cement your broader understanding of the issues discussed throughout the module. It will also be an opportunity to practice using your understanding and analysis skills in a form that will have clear application in industry contexts.

Key Information

This assessment consists of a 15-minute video presentation, in which you record yourself presenting your ethical position on a case study concerning an ethical issue related to AI. You should use visual tools (e.g. PowerPoint slides) to aid the clarity of your presentation, and to ensure that your audience can engage with and follow your argument. You will need to ensure that you are visible on camera alongside your slides.

In preparing your assessment, you should also read the key information provided on how to prepare and submit your presentation, available in the **Assessed Presentation Guidelines** (available from the Assessment area of Minerva).

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Task

This **video presentation** assessment takes place in **Unit 7**.

For this, you will **choose a case study concerning an ethical issue related to AI**. This can be a case study covered somewhere in the module, or it can be a case study you have found/chosen yourself.

You will **record yourself presenting your ethical position on this issue**. You will set out the most convincing **argument for the position on how we should respond ethically to the issue raised** in this case study.

Your argument should **set out the grounds for why any reasonable person should agree with your position on this issue**. This should also **encompass responding to, or addressing, any pressing possible objections to your position**; i.e. those that are likely to be in the minds of the audience (and any that might not be, but which you have already anticipated and dealt with).

You can also **include proposals for particular policies or regulation concerning how we should respond to this issue**. Note, however: those proposals should be set out and grounded in ethical reasoning; i.e. you should make clear what the ethical reasons are supporting such policy proposals, and how to respond to objections.

As with putting forward any ethical position, you should make clear the following:

- The **purpose** of your presentation. What is the problem or issue under discussion? What position on the problem should we take, which you are going to develop the case for?
- The **reasoning** (evidence, support, arguments) for **endorsing** your position (view, proposal).

And:

- The **reasoning** (evidence, support, arguments) behind any pressing **objections** to your position.
- The **reasoning** (evidence, support, arguments) for **rejecting** those objections (view, position) to your position.

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Additional guidance:

Typically, you can arrive at these by considering, when asked to respond to a given question, these sorts of prompts for further thinking:

1. What is your initial reaction to that question?

2. Why did you have your reaction? Why might it be an accurate judgement?

3. Are there any ways you can question your reaction? Why might it be too quick a judgement?

4. Are the points identified in (3) problematic for your thoughts on (1) and (2)?

Prompt (**1)** can help you arrive at your view.

Prompt (**2**) can help you arrive at reasons to agree with your view.

Prompt (**3**) can help you arrive at possible objections to your view.

Prompt (**4**) can help you arrive at ways of resolving those objections. Or: it could help you arrive at reasons for rejecting your initial viewpoint in (**1**).

Note that engaging fully with the non-assessed video exercises (in other units) is necessary for gaining a holistic understanding of the topic and developing your presentation skills. The more opportunities you take for engaging in these exercises, the more you develop the skills and knowledge to demonstrate in the assessment.

You might also like to consult the advice offered by the University of Leeds' Skills @ Library website, which provides useful information about designing and delivering presentations. You can find out more here: Skills @ Library advice on presentations.

Presentation

Your video presentation should adhere to the guidelines on presentation of coursework as set out in **Section 3.2a of the Code of Practice on Assessment.**

The time limit for this assignment is **15 minutes**. Adhering to the time limit is an extremely important aspect of good academic practice. Your presentation should be no shorter than 13 minutes.

If your presentation is longer than the specified time limit, this may be reflected in the mark awarded and noted through individual feedback given to you.

For further information about the penalties for exceeding the assessment limits, please refer to **Section 3.3d of the Code of Practice on Assessment**.

Referencing

It is important that you show that you have engaged with appropriate literature and make efforts to explicitly cite all the sources that you have used or have shaped your thinking. All sources that you draw on in your presentation should be correctly referenced using the Harvard style both for in-presentation citations and in a reference list at the end of the presentation. It is also helpful and good practice to give page numbers for anywhere you're referring to a specific claim/idea/argument from another author, during the presentation.

See the Library webpages for guidance.

Submission

Submit your Video Presentation by the due date and time via the Gradescope submission link found in the 'Submit my work' folder. You should submit only the presentation file.

Your 9 digit student ID number should be used as the document file name and entered as the 'submission title' when you upload your presentation file via Gradescope.

Use the Select File(s) button to select the correct file(s) that you want to upload from your device.

Video files are typically larger and therefore may take some time, a progress bar will appear in the top-left corner of the interface indicating how much of your file is left to upload. Do not navigate away from the page or open another tab, this will only slow the process down.

When the upload is complete the Submit & View Submission button will become active, select it to complete your submission.

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Marking

This is a compulsory assessment for **OCOM5202M Ethics of Artificial Intelligence**. It is worth **80%** of your overall module grade.

The marks will be distributed using the attached assessment criteria.

Feedback

You will receive your mark and feedback via Minerva in the **Gradebook** section, accessed from the main navigation menu at the top of the page.

We will notify you by email when your feedback is available. You will usually receive feedback within 15 working days of the assignment deadline.

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Reading List

The reading list and online course readings for this module can be found in the Learning Resources section of Minerva.

Additional Information and Support

Key Documents

Please ensure that you read and familiarise yourself with the following important documents, available in the Artificial Intelligence Online organisation area on Minerva:

- Digital Education Service (DES) Code of Practice on Assessment
- Code of Practice on Attendance

Skills@Library

Skills@Library provides support for students to develop academic skills. This includes areas such as researching, writing, note making and referencing. This support is delivered through online resources, workshops and webinars: http://library.leeds.ac.uk/skills.

General Module Forum

The Digital Education Service and the University of Leeds are committed to supporting students. If you have any questions about the academic content of the module, please post them in the module's 'General Module Forum' discussion board. You can access this through the 'Discussion Board' section of Minerva. The Module Team will reply to your post and your peers will also have access to the answer.

Student Success Advisor

If you have any questions about using Minerva, administrative processes, or pastoral care please contact your Student Success Advisor. They will be able to advise you or signpost you to the correct resource.

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Recording Policy

As part of your study on this module, webinars will be recorded by the University. This recording is conducted in accordance with the University's Policy on Audio or Video Recording for Educational Purposes. Please read the Policy for further background information relating to your rights. The purpose of the recording is to support your study at the University. It will be accessible by students enrolled on the module through Minerva.

In accordance with the University's Intellectual Property Policy in general where staff or students make a recording, all rights in that recording (including rights in the sounds made) will belong to the University. The University seeks to respect student and staff rights to be acknowledged as authors and performers. Otherwise, to the extent allowed under the general law, any individual interests in the recordings are waived, allowing the University to act in effect as a custodian, to maximise educational objectives in the general interest of all.

If you have any concerns relating to the recording please contact the individual leading the educational activity, or the module leader. If you wish to opt out of being recorded or wish to request that your contribution be edited please contact the individual leading the activity or the module leader in advance of the session (for optouts) or immediately after the session (for requests for edits). Please note that you may not opt out of recordings which form part of the assessment process on the module. If you have any concerns relation to the recording, please contact your Student Success Advisor.

Complaints

If you have any complaints about this module, please write to DESStudents@leeds.ac.uk and the Digital Education Service will review your complaint. If a remedy cannot be arrived at, the University's official complaints procedure could be followed.

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